The Outsider

Karl

New Euphersa is a thriving place—at least for now. Consider this: how could a society where everyone, regardless of age, gender, or physical condition, receives the life, property, and respect they deserve simply by obeying laws, accepting governance, and fulfilling their duties possibly be declining, barren, shriveled, or bitter? Unless you are someone who rejects order—someone labeled an outsider. From the very first second your foot crosses the border into New Euphersa, you will feel the nation's efficient operation, its order, and stability.

New Euphersa has a prime minister, a government, and a clear leadership structure. Without authority and a central decision-making core, such a country simply cannot function. Power is not shameful; on the contrary, it is the concentrated expression of responsibility. History has repeatedly shown that societies denying the existence of power eventually collapse into chaos. Therefore, when children born in New Euphersa begin to display obvious signs of defiance, parents must immediately apply corrective education as prescribed by law—only after the child fully understands how their actions disrupt social order can they return to normal life.

Of course, there are many forms of "correction." For instance, in schools, students who refused to follow classroom procedures were once required to stand at the back of the classroom for three days and nights until they submitted a written acknowledgment of having disrupted the teaching order. At this point, outsiders would inevitably ask: why weren't the students who initiated the conflict treated the same way? That's perfectly normal—the law only addresses explicit violations of order, not subjective dissatisfaction. The student required to reflect admitted personally that this was a lawful administrative measure. After that, no one asked further questions. And endless questioning itself, under certain circumstances, may also be regarded as a disruption of order.

Almost every child in New Euphersa undergoes similar education. It is highly effective. Generally, after just a few experiences, rebellious thoughts are replaced by rationality. Only then do they truly begin to grow, proudly becoming citizens of New Euphersa and contributing to the nation's stability and prosperity.

Everyone, regardless of gender or status—though here, identity differences are not emphasized; there is only one legal status: citizen.

New Euphersa's territory is not particularly large. Neighboring countries know it as a land surrounded by high mountains, connected to the outside world through only one major passage. All daily trade and travel must pass through this route and undergo unified government inspection. For security reasons, New Euphersa citizens rarely travel abroad; instead, foreigners mostly enter the country, since frequent movement is considered detrimental to social stability. There was even a period when this passage was completely closed, until assessments confirmed that external conditions were temporarily manageable.

Except for outsiders, all citizens of New Euphersa must regularly attend meetings—some monthly, others weekly. These meetings primarily focus on the government's established development plans, including production, management, and planning. Led by government representatives, citizens may voice opinions within a defined framework, but final decision-making authority remains with the official institutions. Once a plan is approved, it must be strictly implemented. This is seen as a demonstration of efficiency and fairness.

Power is not inherently bad.

Citizens do not shy away from the word "command," because command signifies the transmission of responsibility. Through documents, regulations, and propaganda materials, the government consistently emphasizes the importance of order and criticizes the dangers of disorder and individualism, seemingly striving to make everyone understand: civilization depends on power. To outsiders, such a society appears oppressive—like a train bound by iron tracks. But they fail to grasp that it is precisely these tracks that prevent the nation from derailing.

"New Euphersia is the most stable nation in the world, maintaining order and security even as chaos and war engulf the outside world," reads the first page of *The Development History of New Euphersia*. This is not meant for boasting, but to ensure every citizen internalizes this fundamental principle and incorporates it into rational

judgment.

What drives New Euphersia's progress? Outsiders always ask this question. How childish. Better to focus on one's own work than waste energy on such inquiries. Outsiders are always like this—obsessed with questioning while ignoring reality.

They must be told: the answer lies in the state, in law, in unified will. These are not abstract concepts, but concrete institutional arrangements—the very foundation upon which society operates. Through these mechanisms, the government ensures that every citizen lives within a controlled environment.

Where there is a state, there is government; where there is government, there are officials. The Prime Minister emerges through established procedures, exercising administrative authority on behalf of the state's will. It may be hard to imagine, in a country so focused on order, that citizens are still encouraged to express opinions. Yet this is true—only within legal boundaries.

The Prime Minister's duties are clear: to explain policy, issue directives, and maintain stability. He typically appears in formal attire, standing before a podium, articulating national positions in precise and restrained language. Citizens generally trust him, believing it is precisely these clear instructions that keep society running smoothly. For centuries, this structure has remained unshaken.

No one has ever seen the physical form of "state will," nor can anyone prove whether it truly represents every individual. But citizens believe—and are willing to believe.

Someone once questioned whether the Prime Minister genuinely represented public opinion. That person was later registered as an outsider.

After a moment of silence, the Prime Minister said:

"The law has already answered."

Some describe state will as a strict yet rational parent, calm and clear-eyed; others see it as an abstract set of neutral rules—devoid of emotion, yet reliable enough. Both descriptions hold true, because as long as people accept its legitimacy, state will can be understood in any necessary form. Of course, outsiders' portrayals are usually regarded as dangerous distortions—their depictions of the state often present it as a cold, alienated monster oppressing individuals under the guise of order. This is clearly mistaken, a misreading of reality, and one that must be corrected.

Citizens of New Euphersia rarely maintain deep connections with the outside world. Those designated as outsiders, or foreign arrivals who refuse to conform to order, must undergo lengthy and rigorous procedures to leave—passing through checkpoints with multiple layers of scrutiny, repeatedly subjected to identity and ideological verification. In practice, only business personnel move in and out frequently.

Merchants are among the few permitted to travel back and forth regularly. They follow rules, comply with oversight, and conduct trade within legal frameworks. Their calls for sale are licensed, their goods inspected, their prices monitored. Rights and obligations of both buyers and sellers are clearly defined, resulting in rare disputes. Citizens don't know what these goods mean beyond the borders, nor do they care. They simply need to know that these transactions benefit the state.

One day—or rather, soon to be a day—in a remote corner at the edge of the city, far from the administrative center. This place is unimportant, as similar areas exist throughout New Euphersia.

At first, no one noticed anything unusual. Everything continued according to established procedures—not every verbal deviation draws attention, nor does every sign of discomfort require immediate intervention.

Until someone realized that one person could no longer perform his duties properly.

His speech began to break down, becoming fragmented and unclear, unable to respond accurately to instructions. At first, this was considered a temporary issue caused by short-term stress. In New Euphelia, such occurrences were not uncommon.

But soon, his condition drew increasing attention.

The streets that day appeared no different from usual—people worked, walked, and conversed as they always did. Yet in a corner unnoticed by most, an anomaly began to emerge—one that should not have gone ignored.

He stood there, visibly unbalanced. His skin had taken on unnatural changes; his facial features were distorted, making it nearly impossible to discern his original identity. He tried to speak, but only fragmented, meaningless syllables escaped—like indecipherable noise.

Onlookers kept their distance. Some asked if he needed help; others began contacting the authorities. He flailed his arms erratically, as if trying to ward something off or defend himself.

His lips moved clearly—he was speaking—but no one could understand.

As more people gathered, the scene gradually attracted notice, becoming the most unusual sight of that day in New Euphelia.

Suddenly, he rose and ran with an almost uncontrollable urgency, as though fleeing an invisible pursuer. His body seemed increasingly unstable under the citizens' gaze—his outline blurred, his movements disordered.

He collapsed to his knees, attempting to write something on the ground, as if trying to prove or explain. The symbols he scrawled were chaotic, defying all known writing systems. His fingers bled as he repeatedly rubbed them raw, mixing blood with ink,

leaving behind incomprehensible marks.

The symbols grew denser, yet their structure continued to collapse. They resembled data spiraling out of control—accumulated, yet incapable of forming coherent meaning.

Among the crowd, some felt discomfort, others left quietly, while a few remained calm, waiting for officials to arrive.

Then, an indescribable transformation occurred.

His body slowly lost human form. A rigid texture formed across his skin, as if he no longer belonged within the realm recognizable by society's systems. Finally, he ceased all movement.

The site was swiftly cordoned off.

That night, many citizens reported similar dreams. They dreamed of vast, stable spaces—silent, without deviation, where everyone moved in unison. There was no chaotic language, only clear direction. Upon waking, they felt a sense of peace.

By the next morning, the area had been completely cleared. No trace of the incident remained.

In its official statement, the government described the event as an extreme isolated case. The individual involved had been properly handled and posed no threat to social order. Citizens generally expressed understanding.

The handling of outliers has long been a critical issue in New Euphelia. It is typically managed by government agencies through legal procedures. First comes identity verification, followed by assessment of potential for reintegration into society.

If conditions permit, individuals undergo psychological counseling, language training, and ideological education. In most cases, these measures are effective. Those who successfully complete the process often appear more orderly and efficient than before, as if they've finally found their proper place.

Of course, there are rare cases where transformation fails.

After multiple interventions, if an individual still cannot clearly express intent or continues to produce speech beyond comprehension, allowing them to remain in public life may pose greater risks.

For the sake of social stability, the government relocates such individuals to more secluded, tightly controlled zones. This is not punishment, but a necessary governance measure. Not every voice holds public value, nor does every thought belong to be disseminated.

For those who have completely lost their capacity for socialization and can no longer form stable cognitive structures, citizens generally regard this not as tragedy, but as a failed case. Society cannot halt its function for the sake of a few who fail to adapt to its rules.

Therefore, no one feels excessively sorrowful about it.

New Euphersa remains prosperous, stable, and efficiently running. Everything is under the control of the system.

Except for those designated as outsiders.

Some are identified in time, can still be corrected, and eventually reintegrated into society. They tend to become more cautious, more obedient, seemingly having fully grasped the importance of order.

But those who are utterly unable to adapt will be permanently excluded from the passages. They are no longer allowed entry into New Euphersa; even if they attempt to disguise their identities, the system will recognize them.

Some citizens believe—this is merely a reasonable inference—that these outsiders fail

to integrate because they refuse to accept the legitimacy of authority. Their words are filled with denial and doubt, yet they offer no viable alternatives. To the people of New Euphersa, such speech is meaningless, mere noise.

Once, a citizen asked a merchant what exactly the outsiders were saying beyond the borders. The merchant replied:

“They say that New Euphersa does not exist, nor does national will.”

A ridiculous claim. The nation is right here; order is right here. The outsiders simply refuse to acknowledge reality.

Later, the passage where this merchant resided was permanently sealed.

It is said that before New Euphersa was even founded, another group of outsiders had established a nation. How absurd! It’s clearly ironic—how could a flourishing country arise without power and command?

Even if you hear: that place is thriving. Think about it—how could a land where every man, woman, child, old or young, healthy or disabled, receives their rightful livelihood, assets, and respect possibly be decaying, barren, shriveled, or bitter? You would feel the nation's vitality the very second your foot crosses the border of Euphersa, sense its peace and harmony. Unless, of course, you are an outsider...

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